



When you think of a CCG (collectible card game), deck builder, or card battler game, the first thing that usually comes to mind is *Hearthstone*, or the more recent *Legends of Runeterra*. Of course, they in turn are inspired by even older card games like *Magic: the Gathering* (heck, we could even drop the *Pokémon* card game here). While we may not be familiar with *Magic: the Gathering*, we are familiar with shows like *Yu-Gi-Oh*, or the less popular *Duel Masters*, which were also card battlers. All of these have plenty in common; the hunt for the strongest and rarest cards, theorycrafting the strongest decks, pitting your creation against other players to see how it fares – and then you're back to square one when you get stomped by pros who have PhDs in the game. This aspect of card games make them one of the most competitive genres out there; also let's not forget, *Clash Royale* is technically a deck builder too, and it is one of the most competitive games on mobile.

However, there's a lot more to card games if you delve deeper, games from indie studios that experiment and combine card game mechanics with genres in a way you might never have thought possible. We'd probably never have known we could have a deck builder roguelike before *Slay the Spire*

came along – which is obviously on this list. So without further ado, let's take a look at some of the best card games you can play right now. Not counting *Solitaire*.

MAGIC: THE GATHERING ARENA



Magic: The Gathering is one of the most popular card games period. The game has been around for a long time, easily longer than anything else on this list. As a result, the game has been through a plethora of changes, with multiple formats and gameplay possibilities. Bring all of those possibilities to a digital format, and you have *Magic: The Gathering Arena*,

which pairs the game with the visual and animation overhaul you expect from a video game. It's a match made in heaven; who doesn't want to see iconic creatures and characters from fantasy come alive on their screen? What's more, it's a great place to find and compete against

other players, a task that was otherwise rather tedious.

LEGENDS OF RUNETERRA

Riot Games' card game, *Legends of Runeterra* is, in our opinion, one of the best card games you can play. Being a bit late to the party, it's had a lot of examples to learn from; and as such, it